

## MAKING REFERRALS FOR PSYCHOLOGICAL ASSESSMENT

After administering the *Learning Needs Screening* to an individual, if results indicate referral for further assessment is needed and no formal assessment has been done or no documentation of a previous diagnosis is available, the individual may need to be referred to another agency for formal assessment to determine the nature of the problem.

### Referral to a Certifying Professional through the DRS

In many cases students will qualify for assessment services through the Division of Rehabilitation Services (DRS). To qualify, a client must be seeking future employment. When making referrals, it is important to make it clear to the intake counselor that the individual's lack of documentation prohibits the individual from accessing needed accommodations and thus **poses a barrier to further training or career advancement**.

### Referral Directly to a Professional Diagnostician

Adult students who are employed and have private insurance may want to be referred to a private "certifying professional."

### What to Send to DRS or the Professional Diagnostician:

When making your referral, include the following information

- Photocopy or scan the referral form onto your program letterhead.
- Provide as much information as you have collected (assessment scores from TABE or CASAS, *Learning Needs Screening*, copies of any old records you have collected, notes of any difficulties you have observed, notes on any strategies or accommodations you have used successfully, etc.).
- Make sure you explain that you think the student may have a learning disability or an attention problem, or another type of disability. Make sure you identify this—vision problem, learning problem, etc. (This will determine what the referring agency or doctor will evaluate the person for in regards to the possible disability.)
- Have the student sign the *Release of Information to External Agencies* listing the items you are sending.
- Have the student sign a *Request for Records* so that you can receive the results of the formal assessment and discuss the case with the DRS counselor.

If the individual is seeking a High School Equivalency, explain that a professional diagnostician will need to determine if the student is indeed eligible for accommodations. The diagnostician needs to determine what the disability is and what accommodations need to be made for instruction and testing purposes.

## SPECIAL LEARNING NEEDS REFERRAL

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

**Referral to:**

Attention: \_\_\_\_\_

Agency: \_\_\_\_\_

Address: \_\_\_\_\_

**From:**

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Title: \_\_\_\_\_

Telephone: \_\_\_\_\_

Email: \_\_\_\_\_

**Regarding:**

Student Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Address: \_\_\_\_\_

SS#: \_\_\_\_\_

Date of Birth: \_\_\_\_\_

Phone: \_\_\_\_\_

Email: \_\_\_\_\_

I am referring this student from the WVAdultEd program to your office because he or she has experienced learning difficulties that could pose an impediment to training or employment.

Our program seeks to assist its students as is fair and appropriate according to the *Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)* and other pertinent preceding legislation. Our goal is to provide the opportunity for unimpaired instruction and testing for individuals with disabilities.

Many of our students hope to attain the high school equivalency diploma but may need special accommodations in order to pass the examination due to disabilities or certain psychological impairments. A professional diagnostician must perform a psychological, neuropsychological or physical evaluation (depending on the types of disabilities) in order for a student to receive appropriate accommodations as specified by the American Council on Education.

In addition, our students also require documentation of their disabilities for a variety of future educational and vocational purposes. Some of our students with learning difficulties may have low intelligence or physical or psychological impairments which will make it difficult for them to achieve academically or prepare for vocational programs. Alternative training programs may be necessary for these individuals to prepare for the world of work. Again, formal assessment is needed to determine options for these students. To serve our students adequately, we require specific information about their learning potential in comparison with achievement and about their instructional needs.

We have also enclosed the Student's signed ***Request for Information***, giving you written permission to send copies of assessment results and reports directly to our program.

**For your information** and with the student's signed permission, we have enclosed the following:

High School Equivalency Testing Accommodations Attachment  
Learning Needs Screening results  
Test of Adult Basic Education (TABE) scores  
Comprehensive Adult Student Assessment System (CASAS) scores  
TASC Readiness Assessment scores  
School Records (including IEP records)  
Other: \_\_\_\_\_

Please send all forms and reports to the following address:

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Address: \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

Telephone: \_\_\_\_\_ Fax: \_\_\_\_\_

Please contact us if we can be of further help. Thank you for your assistance.